REBUTTAL TO ARGUMENT IN FAVOR OF MEASURE E

Measure E expands Solano County's business license tax beyond the current scope by adding new rates for wind turbines, commercial solar systems, battery energy storage, natural gas extraction facilities, and data centers, while also increasing the wind rate. It is presented as a minor update that "generates approximately $353,000 annually," but that modest figure does not match the range of the tax expansion and its long-term economic effects.

When business taxes rise, operating costs rise. Those costs are passed on to consumers through higher prices, fees, and financing costs. That means residents, especially working families, can end up paying more for everyday goods and services, not just helping fund County priorities.

The measure's "fairness" framing also conflicts with its details. It raises the wind rate by more than 160% and adds entirely new taxes on solar and battery facilities. By changing project economics, these charges can discourage investment in clean energy and the construction and long-term jobs that come with it.

Measure E also imposes a $5 per square foot tax on data centers, which may make Solano less competitive for technology employers and energy developers.

Finally, Measure E includes automatic annual inflation increases and lacks a true sunset date. Although it says it lasts "until ended by the voters," ending a tax would require a new ballot initiative and significant signature collection.

Solano County should pursue targeted, transparent funding instead of an open-ended, inflation-adjusted expansion of business taxes.

VOTE NO on MEASURE E.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael T Nolan, President

s/ Shari Borkin
Dixon resident